CCSA103 Lab: Object Management

Course: Check Point Certified Security Administrator (CCSA) R82
Instructor: Bello Ridwan Olayinka
Student Name: Yahaya Muhammad Nasir
Reg No: C11/26/CCSA/17020
Date: 6th - 11th - 2026

Part 1: Hands-On Lab Tasks

Task 1: Modify a Network Object

Objective

To modify the existing A-DMZ-NET network object by changing its colour and comment in SmartConsole.

Configuration Details

Settings	Value
Object	A-DMZ-NET
Color	Orange
Comment	Alpha-Site Demilitarized Zone - Modified by Yahaya

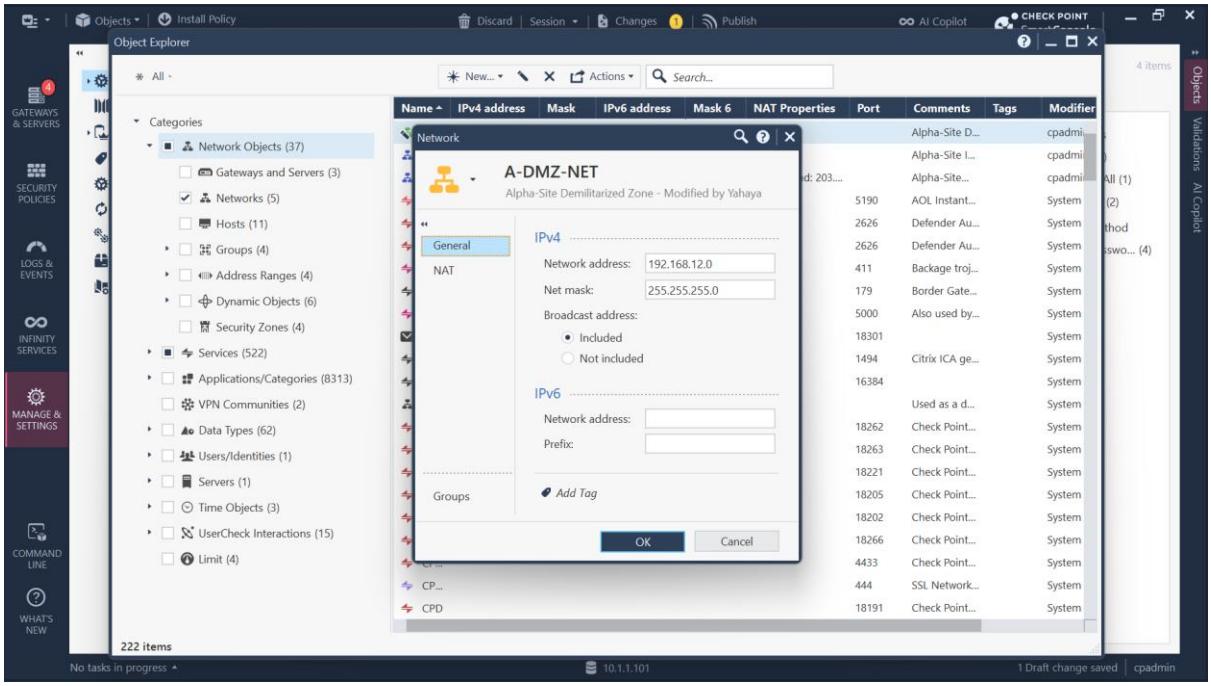


Fig. A Modified A-DMZ-NET object

Procedure

1. Logged in to SmartConsole on A-SMS.
2. Navigated to Objects → Object Explorer.
3. Expanded Network Objects → Networks.
4. Opened the A-DMZ-NET object.
5. Changed the object colour to Orange.
6. Updated the comment field as specified.

7. Clicked OK to save the changes.

Observation
The colour change makes the object easier to identify visually within SmartConsole, while the comment provides a clear description of the object's purpose and modification history. The object remained functional, with only its administrative properties updated.

Result
The A-DMZ-NET network object was successfully updated with the new colour and comment. The object icon changed to orange and the modified comment was displayed in the object properties.

Task 2: Create a New Host Object

Objective
To create a new host object in SmartConsole for use in future security policies and network management tasks.

Configuration Details

Setting	Value
Name	Student-Web-Server
IPv4 Address	192.168.12.150
Comment	Internal Web Server for Lab
Color	Sea Green

Procedure

1. Opened the Objects menu in SmartConsole.
2. Selected New Host.
3. Entered the hostname Student-Web-Server.
4. Assigned the IPv4 address 192.168.12.150.
5. Added the comment "Internal Web Server for Lab".
6. Selected Sea Green as the object colour.
7. Clicked OK to create the host object.

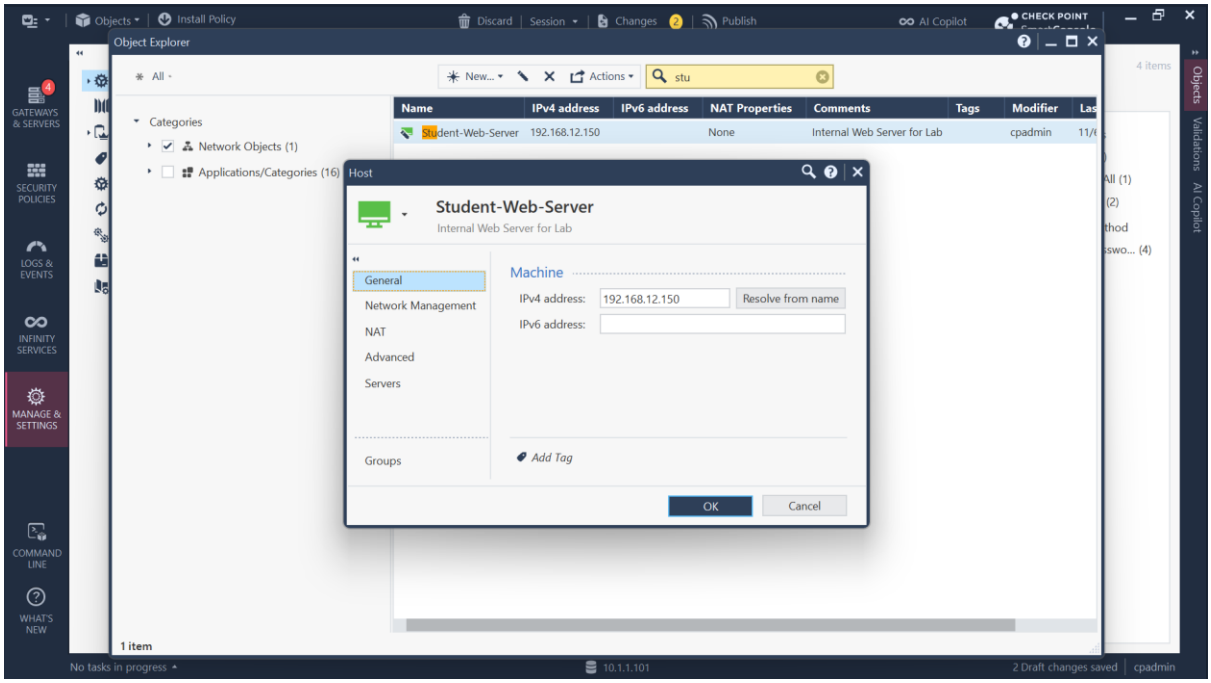


Fig. Student-Web-Server object

Observation

Creating a host object allows a specific device to be referenced easily in security policies, NAT rules, and object groups. Using meaningful names and comments improves administration and makes policy management easier.

Result

The Student-Web-Server host object was successfully created and appeared under Network Objects → Hosts with a sea green icon.

Task 3: Clone a Service Object

Objective

To create a customized TCP service object by cloning the default HTTP service and modifying its properties without affecting the original service.

Configuration Details

Setting	Value
Name	http_Student_Custom
Comment	Custom HTTP for Lab
Color	Violet Red
Port	Custom: 8081
Session Timeout	Specific: 120 seconds

Procedure

1. Opened Objects → Object Explorer.
2. Expanded Services → TCP.
3. Located the default http service (TCP port 80).
4. Right-clicked the service and selected Clone.
5. Renamed the cloned service to http_Student_Custom.
6. Added the required comment and selected the Violet Red colour.
7. Changed the port number from 80 to 8081.
8. Opened the Advanced tab and set the session timeout to 120 seconds.
9. Clicked OK to save the new service object.

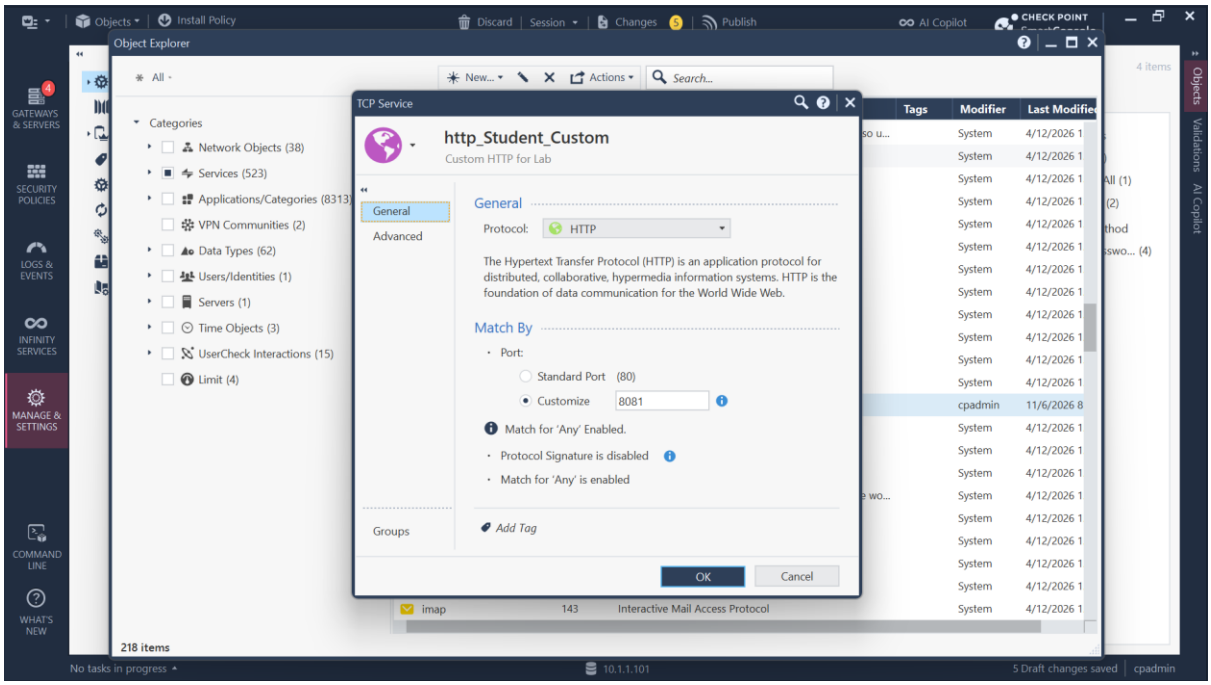


Fig B.1 Custom service object showing: Name, Port, Comment, Colour

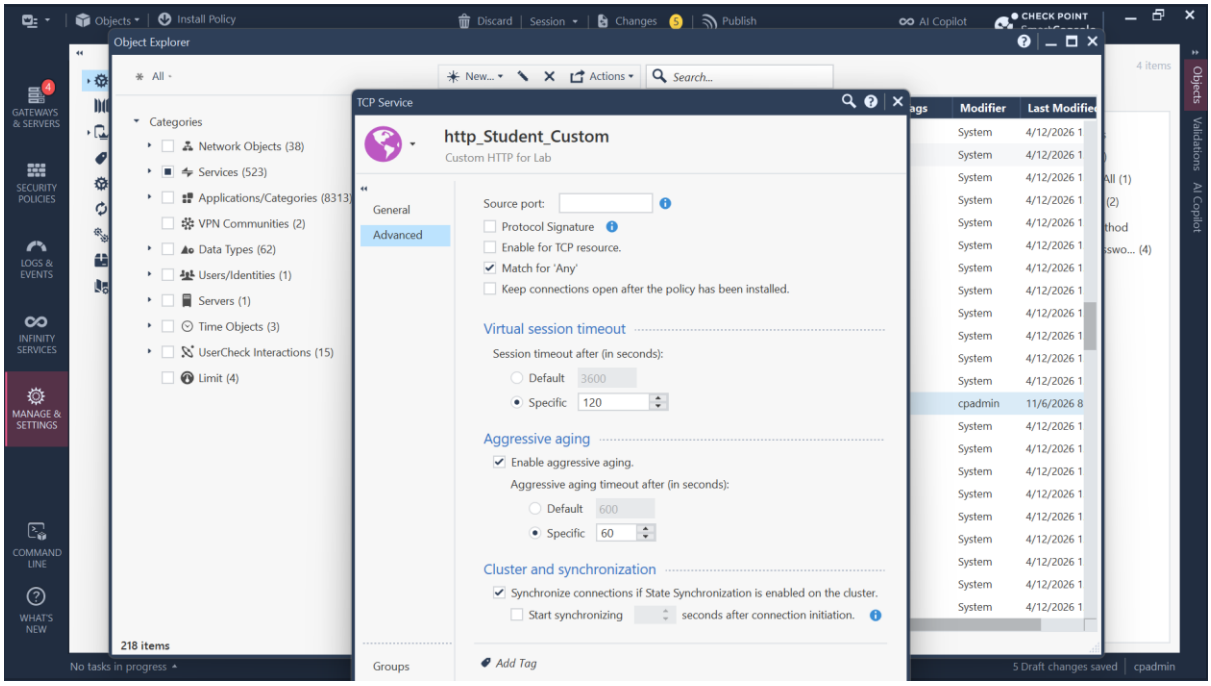


Fig. B.2 Advanced tab showing the 120-second timeout.

Observation

Cloning allows administrators to create customized service definitions without modifying built-in objects. This preserves the integrity of the default HTTP service while creating a new service that can be used for applications operating on TCP port 8081.

Result

The cloned service object http_Student_Custom was successfully created and appeared under Services → TCP. The original HTTP service remained unchanged.

Task 4: Grouping and Verification

Objective

To add the newly created Student-Web-Server host object to an existing group and verify that the membership was successfully updated**.**

Procedure

1. Opened Network Objects → Groups in SmartConsole.
2. Located and opened the Alpha-Web group.
3. Added Student-Web-Server to the group members list.
4. Clicked OK to save the changes.
5. Reopened the Alpha-Web group to verify the membership.

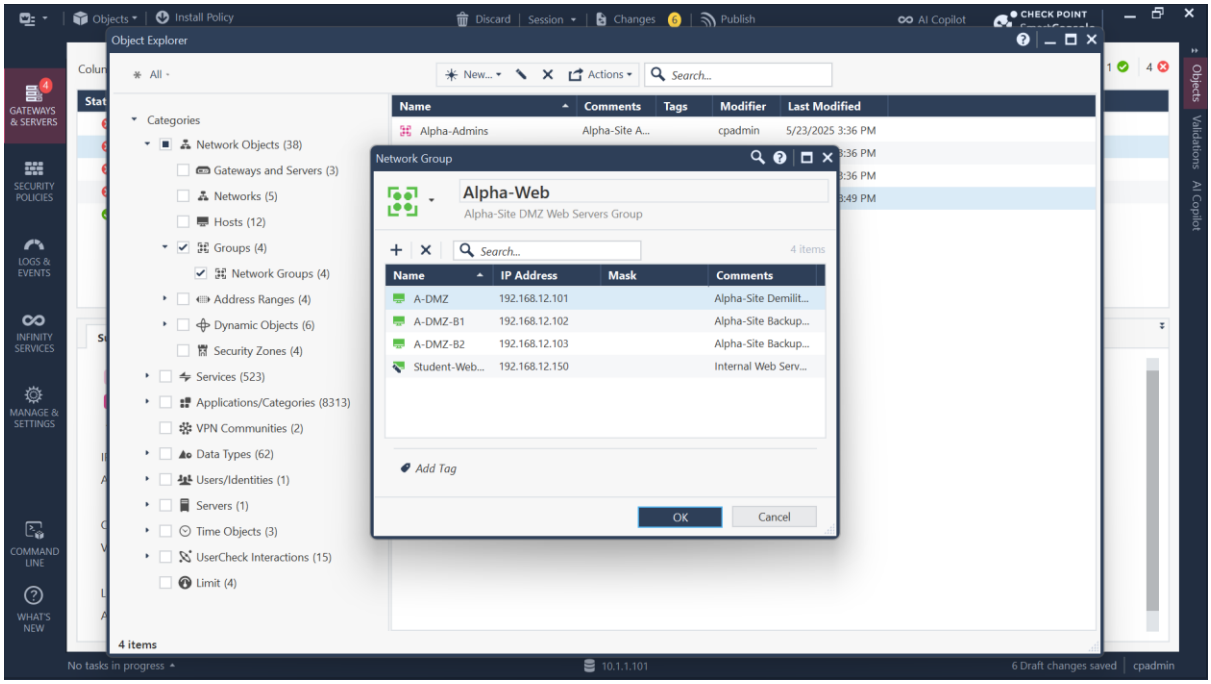


Fig. C Alpha-Web group properties window showing Student-Web-Server in the member list.

Observation

Using groups simplifies policy management by allowing administrators to reference multiple objects with a single group name. Adding Student-Web-Server to the Alpha-Web group enables future security policies to be applied to all web-related systems collectively rather than configuring individual rules for each host**.**

Result

The Student-Web-Server host object was successfully added to the Alpha-Web group and appeared in the group's member list upon verification.

Task 5: Publish and Install

Objective

To publish the configured object changes and install the management database on the designated management servers.

Configuration Details

Setting	Value
Session name	Object Management Lab – Yahaya_Nasir
Install Database targets	A-SMS

Procedure

1. Clicked Publish from the SmartConsole toolbar.
2. Entered the session name Object Management Lab – Yahaya_Nasir.
3. Navigated to Menu → Install Database.
4. Selected A-SMS and A-SME as the installation targets.
5. Clicked Install to deploy the database changes.
6. Opened the Recent Tasks window to verify the installation result.

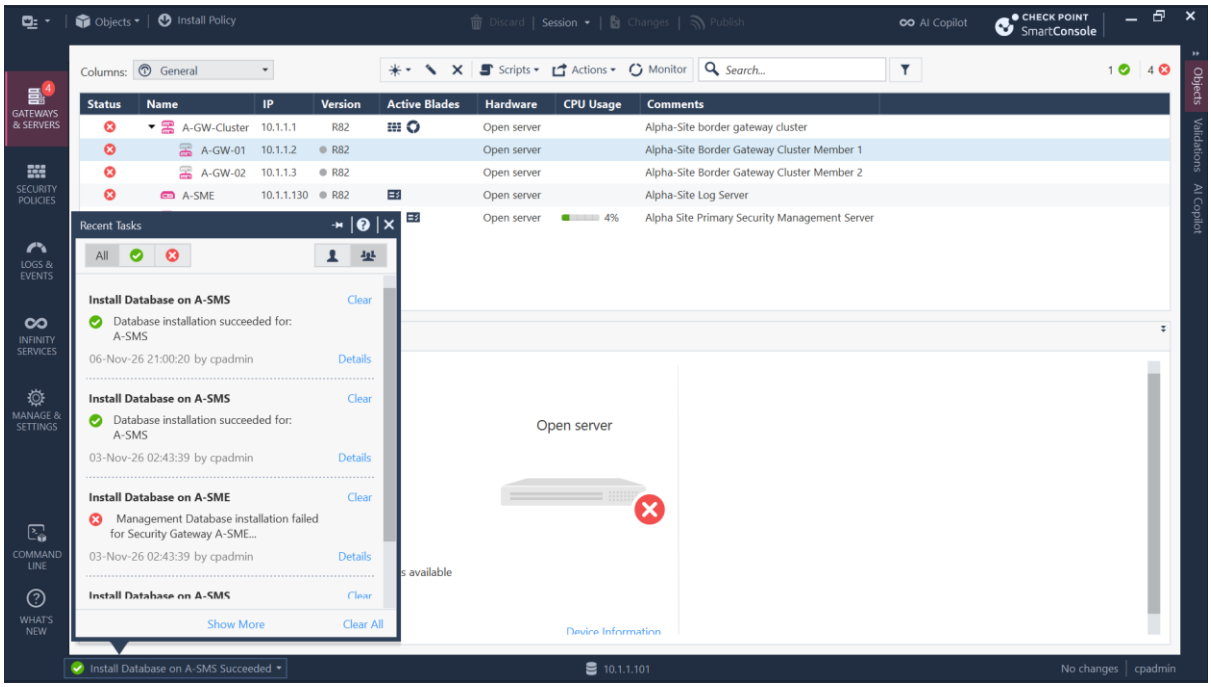


Fig. D success prompt, showing the Database Install completed on A-SMS

Observation

Publishing commits the changes made during the current session to the Security Management Server database, making them visible to other administrators. Installing the database then distributes those changes to the selected management servers. Separating these actions helps ensure that changes can be reviewed before deployment.

Result

The management session was successfully published, and the database installation completed for the selected targets. The Recent Tasks window displayed a successful installation status for both A-SMS and A-SME.

Part 3: Short-Answer Questions

1. **What is a recommended best practice when dealing with default objects in SmartConsole, rather than editing them directly?**
   A recommended best practice is to clone the default object and modify the copy instead of changing the original object. This preserves the default configuration, reduces the risk of affecting other policies, and makes troubleshooting easier if problems occur

2. **Name at least three different ways (menus or locations) you can manage or create objects within SmartConsole.**
   Objects can be managed or created through the Objects menu, Object Explorer, and the New Object toolbar/menu options within SmartConsole. These locations allow administrators to create, edit, organize, and search for network, host, service, and group objects.

3. **What is the Object Explorer, and what is one unique capability it has that the standard New menu does not?**
   The Object Explorer is a central management interface used to view, search, organize, and modify existing objects in SmartConsole. A unique capability of Object Explorer is that it allows administrators to browse and manage all object categories from a single location, including cloning and searching for existing objects.

4. **According to best practices, why should you use Group Objects instead of adding individual objects directly to security rules?**
   Group Objects simplify policy management by allowing multiple related objects to be managed through a single group. When changes are required, administrators only need to update the group membership rather than editing multiple security rules, making administration easier and reducing configuration errors.